A
PROJECT REPORT
ON

STARDUST

(A Startup pitch deck reviewer.)

SUBMITTED BY

Sharma Karan V.
Kariya Hiren P.

ACADEMIC YEAR 2026-27
T.Y B.C.A SEM -5

UNDER THE GUIDANCE OF

Mr. Nikhil Mungra

SMT. C.Z.M GOSRANI B.C.A. COLLEGE
JAMNAGAR

SUBMITTED TO

SAURASHTRA UNIVERSITY
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OSHWAL EDUCATION TRUST MANAGED
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AFFILIATED TO SAURASHTRA UNIVERSITY, RAJKOT & APPROVED BY AICTE

CZMG BCA-135/2026-27/16 Date: 01/10/2026

CERTIFICATE OF PROJECT COMPLETION

This is to certify that the project entitled
"STARDUST-STARTUP IDEA VALIDATION PLATFORM."
is a bonafide work carried out by
Sharma Karan V. (24CS002UG04353)
and **Kariya Hiren P. (24CS002UG04267)**
as a partial fulfillment of the requirements
for the B.C.A. Semester 5 during the
Academic Year 2026-2027.

The project report meets the academic requirements for the project work prescribed by Saurashtra University, Rajkot.

EXAMINER NAME & SIGN	**PRINCIPAL SIGN**
Mr. Nikhil Mungra	/ /2026
PROJECT GUIDE	**EXAM DATE**

ABSTRACT

STARDUST-The Startup Pitchdeck Reviewer Platform is a web based application designed to bridge the gap between startup founders and prospective investors.

The platform enables founders to create accounts, upload their startup pitch decks, and connect with investors seeking promising investment opportunities. Investors can register, browse, filter, and evaluate startups based on industry, funding stage, business model, and portfolio preferences, making the discovery process more efficient. By providing a centralized platform for both founders and investors, the system simplifies fundraising, enhances startup visibility, and streamlines investment decision making.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The feeling of gratefulness to any one's help directly arises from the bottom of heart. A small but an important and timely help can prove to be a milestone in one's life.

This project is dedicated to all the people, whom i met, took guidance, talked, interviewed and learned something from them. At this occasion i sincerely thank all of them while submitting this project report.

I would like to thank **Mr. Nikhil Mungra** for giving time-to-time valuable guidance during the project and giving me guidance in taking my curriculum decision and choosing, initiating and getting on with the project.

I always have felt the invisible help from the almighty, without the blessings of almighty, I could not have succeeded.

PROJECT PROFILE

DEVELOPER	
Name: **(1) Sharma Karan Vindobhai** **(2) Kariya Hiren Punabhai**	**Enrollment Number:** **(1) 24CS002UG04353** **(2) 24CS002UG04267**
PROJECT DETAILS	
Project Title:	Stardust – A Startup Pitchdeck Reviewer
Duration:	3 Months
Name of Project:	Stardust
Platform:	React.JS (Front End) Python & PHP (Back End)
Team Size:	2
GUIDE INFORMATION	
Name of Guides	
MR. NIKHIL MUNGRA	

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06
MAINTENANCE
01
PLANNING
05
TESTING &
INTEGRATION
SDLC
Software
Development
Life Cycle
02
ANALYSIS
04
IMPLEMENTATION
03
DESIGN

2. REQUIREMENT GATHERING AND ANALYSIS

1) ORGANIZATION DETAILS:

1. Name of the Organization: -

Rainmatter Capital Fund

2. Brief detail of the organization: -

Rainmatter Capital Fund by Zerodha is an initiative to fund the future of Indian innovastion and business.

2) MEETINGS:

I. Meeting with Executive

1. Name of Executive

- Mr. Nithin Kamath

2. Executive's requirement in his words.

- Founder's Login, Round based funding pitch, Portfolio based filteration etc.

II. Meeting with user

1. Name of the user.

-Mr. Nithin Kamath

2. User requirement in his words.

- A System is required for Proper funding applications, so founders can smoothly approach the investors.

2.3 Data which will be the input into the system….

- Text
- PDF
- PPTX

2.4 Data which will be the output from the system….

- Text

2.5 Type of project….

- Online

2.6 Method for collecting data.

- Interviews.

3. SYSTEM REQUIREMENT SPECIFICATIONS

3.1 Introduction:

3.1.1 Purpose:

STARDUST is an online web app where startup founders easily approach the investor to pitch for a funding round for their startup, while making it easy for an investor to make a fair quick decision for investing opportunity.

3.1.2 Intended Audience and Reading Suggestions:

The intended audience of this document is the potential end user. The document may also serve as a reference guide to the developers of the system.

3.1.3 Product Scope:

The Application produced will be an online investment web application.

3.2 Overall Description:

3.2.1 Product Function:

(i.) Admin Module :

- Login
- Filter Pitches
- Reject Pitches
- Schedule Meetings
- Maintain Database

(ii.) User Module :

- Register
- Login
- Update Profile
- Apply for funding

3.2.2 User classes and characteristics:

(i.) User Classes :

- Administrator
- User

(ii.) User Characteristics :

(a) Administrator:

Admin must be capable to manage Database & Materials.

(b) User :

User should have basic idea about the online web application.

3.2.3 Operating Environment:

This webapp will operate through the internet including hardware platforms like computers and also operating systems like Windows.

3.2.4 Design and Implementation constraints:

- GUI is only in English.
- Internet connection is required.
- Users should have basic knowledge of Computer

3.2.5 Assumptions and dependencies:

- Administrator is created in the system already.
- The database will be managed by the admin only.
- Roles and tasks are predefined.

3.3 External Interface Requirement:

3.3.1 User Interface:

In case the user is not registered. He/She can enter the details and create an account. Once the account is created user can 'login'. If the username or password is incorrect then an error message appears.

3.3.2 Software Interface:

- Operating System – Windows 10 or above
- Front End – React.js
- Back End – Php Mysql
- Software for Front End – Virtual Studio
- Communication Interface – Xampp

3.4 System Features:

- To provide user login.
- To show founders list.

3.5 Other Nonfunctional Requirements:

3.5.1 Performance requirement:

- Overall System should be fast and error free.
- It should have built in error checking and correction facilities.
- The system should be able to handle large amount of data.

3.5.2 Security Requirement:

- Administrator has more rights than user.

3.5.3 Safety Requirement:

- In order to prevent data loss in case of system failure, the Pdf are saved in the database and can be downloaded from remote system.

3.6 Feasibility Study

A feasibility study is a preliminary investigation of a proposed system to decide whether the system can run smoothly with the organization.

3.6.1 Operational Feasibility: -

Operational feasibility is the measure of how well a proposed system solves the problems, and takes advantage of the opportunities identified during scope definition and how it satisfies the requirements identified in the requirements analysis phase of system development

3.6.2 Technical Feasibility: -

Technical feasibility determines whether the work for the project can be done with the existing equipment, software technology and available personal.

Technical feasibility is concerned with specifying equipment and software that will satisfy the user requirement.

3.6.3 Economic Feasibility: -

Economic feasibility determines whether there are sufficient benefits in creating to make the cost acceptable, or is the cost of the system too high.

So this signifies cost benefit analysis and savings on the behalf of the cost benefit analysis.

3.6.4 Schedule Feasibility: -

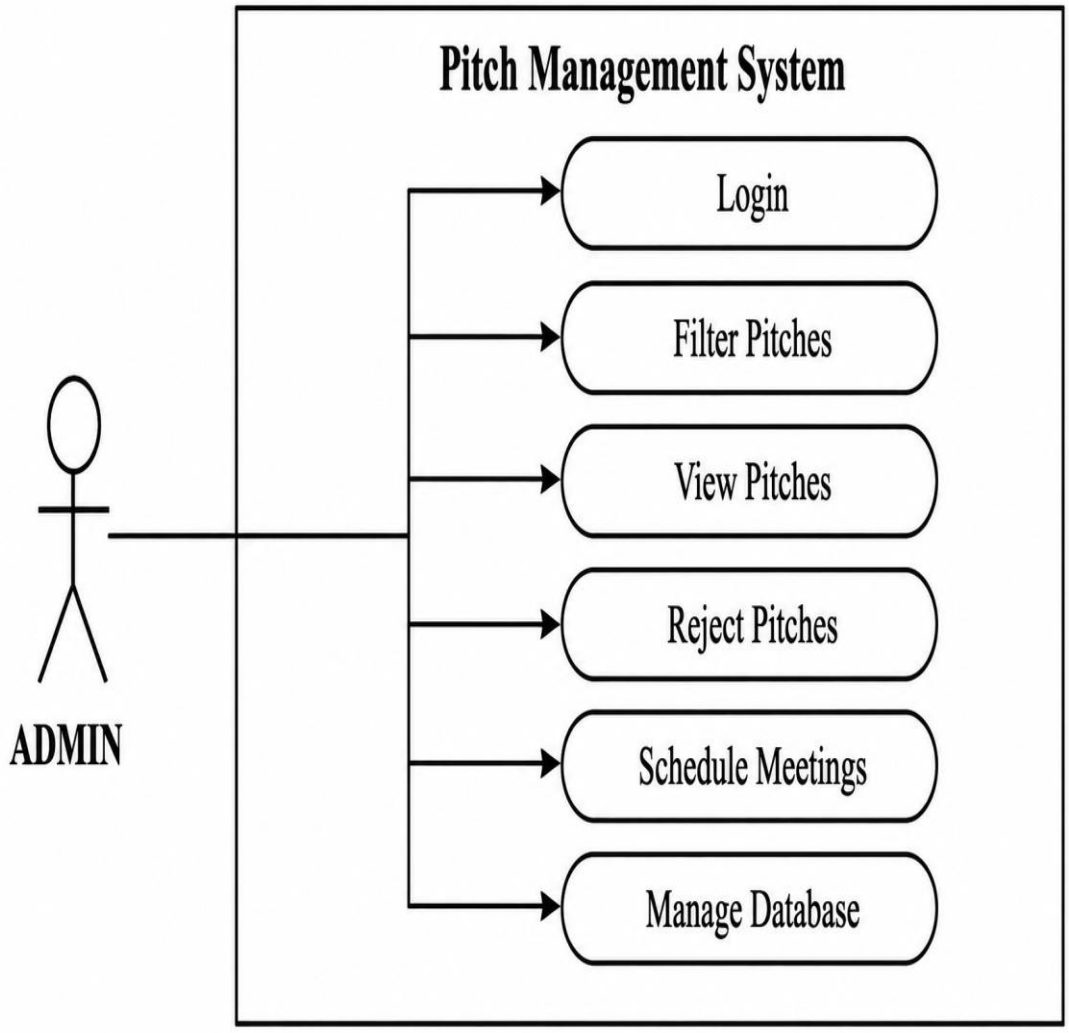
How long will it take to get the technical expertise?

We may have the technology, but that doesn't mean we have the skills required to properly apply that technology.

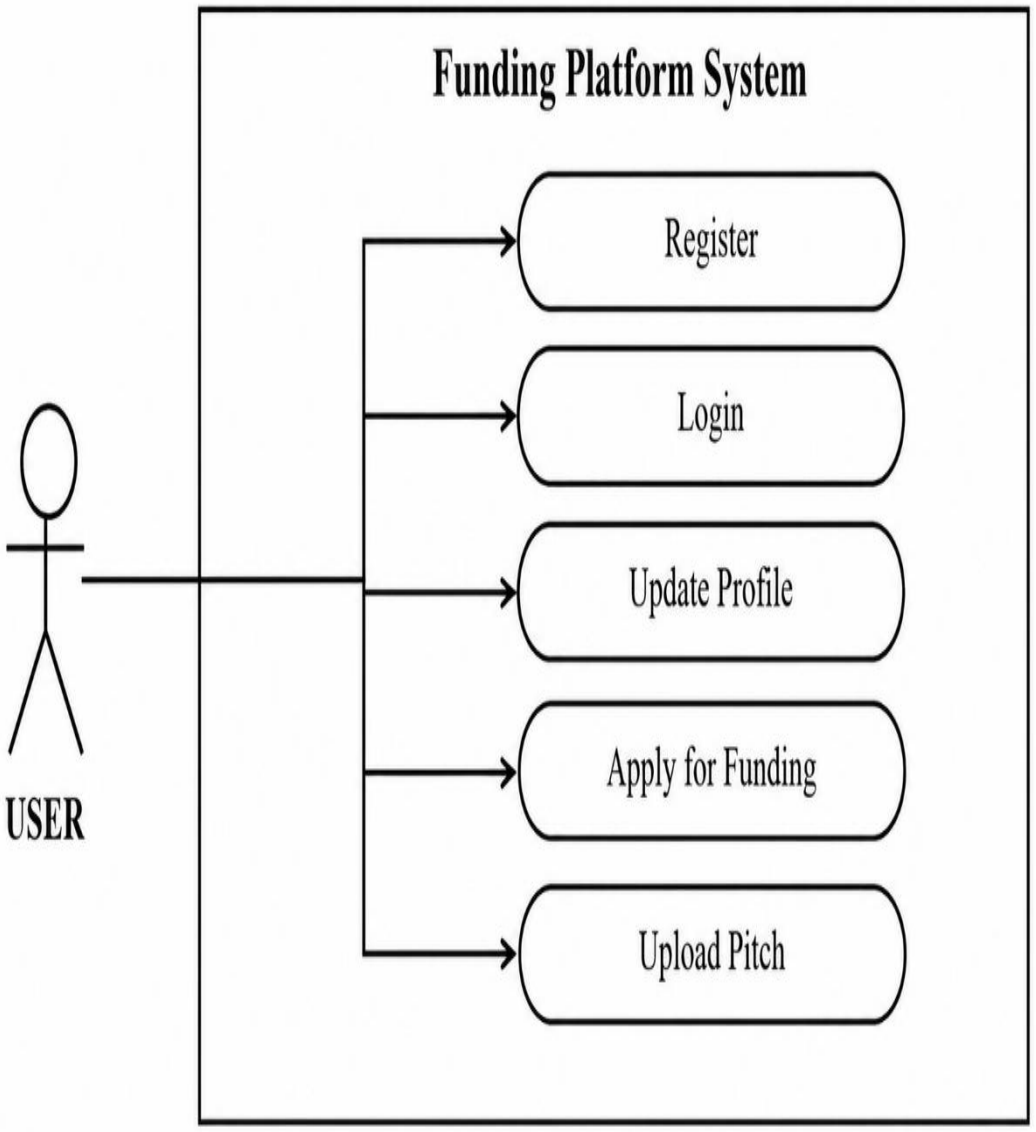
4. SYSTEM ANALYSIS AND MODELING

4.1 Use case Diagram:

1) Admin Side



2) User Side


Funding Platform System
Register
Login
Update Profile
Apply for Funding
Upload Pitch
USER

4.2 Normalization & E-R Diagram:

Normalization is the process of organizing the columns (attributes) and tables (relations) of a relational database to reduce data redundancy and improve data integrity.

- **De Normalized Form:**

Founder ID	Founder Name	Founder Email	Investor ID	Investor Name
1	Hiren Kariya	hirenkariya03@gmail.com	3	Karan Sharma
2	Hiren K	hirenkariya@gmail.com	3	Karan Sharma
2	Hiren K	hirenkariya@gmail.com	2	H.P.Kariya

Firm Name	Startup Name	Industry	Funding Stage	Business Model	Funding Ask
Sindhi Pandit Matromony	Stardust	Fintech	Pre-seed	D2C	2147483647
Sindhi Pandit Matromony	sharkfin	HealthTech	Idea	B2B	12000000
—	sharkfin	HealthTech	Idea	B2B	12000000

Team Size	Investor Preferences	Pitch Status	Investor Note	Meeting Date	Meeting Status
1	SaaS, Fintech, HealthTech...	pending	—	29-09-2026 22:29	pending
1	SaaS, Fintech, HealthTech...	in_review	—	30-09-2026 22:28	pending
1	SaaS, Fintech, HealthTech...	in_review	too hard but possible	—	—

- **Normalized Form:**

A. 1st Normal Form:

1) **Table Name :** founders

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

id	full_name	email	password_hash	phone	created_at
1	Hiren Kariya	hirenkariya03@gmail.com	Hashed Password	NULL	26-09-2026 12:47
2	Hiren K	hirenkariya@gmail.com	Hashed Password	NULL	26-09-2026 17:46

2) Table Name : investors

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

id	full_name	email	password_hash	firm_name	created_at
2	H.P.Kariya	hpkariya@hotmail.com	Hashed Password	NULL	26-09-2026 17:51
3	Karan Sharma	karans@gmail.com	Hashed Password	Sindhi Pandit Matromony	26-09-2026 20:24

3) Table Name : investor_preferences

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

investor_id	industries	funding_stages	business_models	ticket_size_min	ticket_size_max
2	SaaS, Fintech, HealthTech, EdTech, E-commerce, AgriTech, CleanTech, AI/ML, Consumer, DeepTech	Idea, Pre-seed, Seed, Series A, Series B+	Subscription, Marketplace, D2C, B2B, Freemium, Transactional	100000	2147483647

3	SaaS, Fintech, HealthTech, EdTech, E-commerce, AgriTech, CleanTech, AI/ML, Consumer, DeepTech	Idea, Pre-seed, Seed, Series A, Series B+	Subscription, Marketplace, D2C, B2B, Freemium, Transactional	1	2147483647

4) Table Name : pitches

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

id	founder_id	startup_name	tagline	industry
1	1	Stardust	We make investors life easy	Fintech
2	2	sharkfin	we shine at what we do	HealthTech

funding_stage	business_model	funding_ask	team_size	status
Pre-seed	D2C	2147483647	1	pending
Idea	B2B	12000000	1	in_review

5) **Table Name :** investor_notes

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

id	pitch_id	investor_id	note	created_at
1	2	2	too hard but possible	26-09-2026 17:52

6) **Table Name :** meetings

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

id	pitch_id	investor_id	founder_id	proposed_datetime	message	status	created_at
2	2	3	2	30-09-2026 22:28	lets meet	pending	26-09-2026 20:26
3	1	3	1	29-09-2026 22:29	lets meet	pending	26-09-2026 20:27

B. 2nd Normal Form:

1) **Table Name :** founders

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

id	full_name	email	password_hash	phone	created_at
1	Hiren Kariya	hirenkariya03@gmail.com	Hashed Password	NULL	DateTime
2	Hiren K	hirenkariya@gmail.com	Hashed Password	NULL	DateTime

2) Table Name : investors

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

id	full_name	email	password_hash	firm_name	created_at
2	H.P.Kariya	hpkariya@hotmail.com	Hashed Password	NULL	DateTime
3	Karan Sharma	karans@gmail.com	Hashed Password	Sindhi Pandit Matro mony	DateTime

3) Table Name : pitches

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

Foreign Key: founder_id

id	founder_id	startup_name	tagline	industry
1	1	Stardust	We make investors life easy	Fintech
2	2	sharkfin	we shine at what we do	HealthTech

funding_stage	business_model	funding_ask	team_size	status
Pre-seed	D2C	2147483647	1	pending
Idea	B2B	12000000	1	in_review

4) **Table Name :** investor_preferences

Primary Key: investor_id

investor_id	industries	funding_stages	business_models	ticket_size_min	ticket_size_max
2	SaaS, Fintech, HealthTech...	Idea, Pre-seed, Seed...	Subscription, Marketplace...	100000	2147483647
3	SaaS, Fintech, HealthTech...	Idea, Pre-seed, Seed...	Subscription, Marketplace...	1	2147483647

5) **Table Name :** investor_notes

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

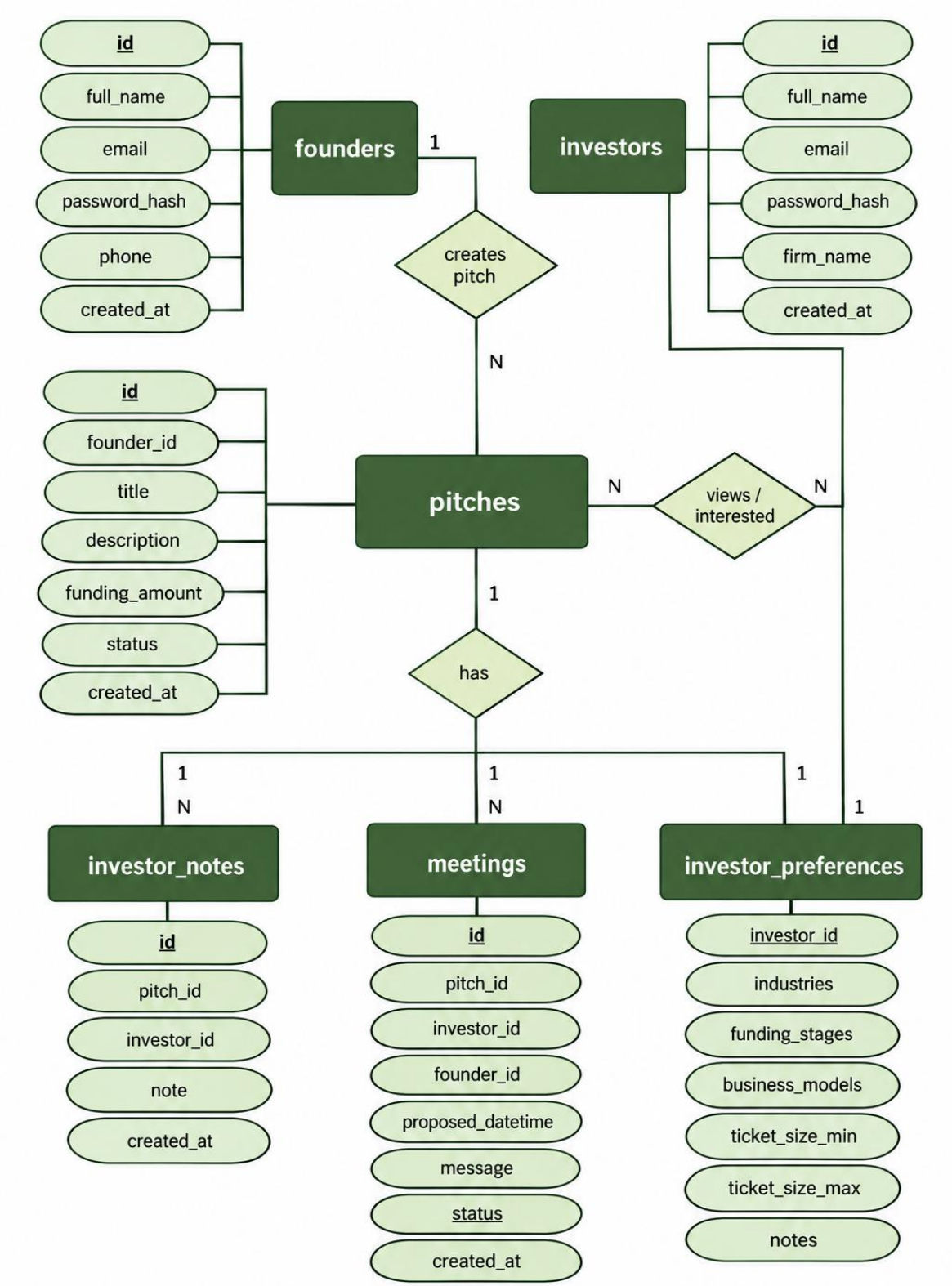
id	pitch_id	investor_id	note	created_at
1	2	2	too hard but possible	DateTime

6) **Table Name :** meetings

Primary Key: id (Auto Increment)

id	pitch_id	investor_id	founder_id	proposed_datetime	message	status	created_at
2	2	3	2	30-09-2026 22:28	lets meet	pending	DateTime
3	1	3	1	29-09-2026 22:29	lets meet	pending	DateTime

➢ E-R Diagram:


id
full_name
email
password_hash
phone
created_at
founders
1
creates pitch
N
investors
id
full_name
email
password_hash
firm_name
created_at
id
founder_id
title
description
funding_amount
status
created_at
pitches
N
views / interested
N
1
has
1
N
1
N
1
1
investor_notes
id
pitch_id
investor_id
note
created_at
meetings
id
pitch_id
investor_id
founder_id
proposed_datetime
message
status
created_at
investor_preferences
investor_id
industries
funding_stages
business_models
ticket_size_min
ticket_size_max
notes

4.3 Data Dictionary

1) founders:

#	Name	Type	Null	Default	Extra
1	id	int(11)	No	None	AUTO_INCREMENT
2	full_name	varchar(120)	No	None	
3	email	varchar(150)	No	None	
4	password_hash	varchar(255)	No	None	
5	phone	varchar(30)	Yes	NULL	

2) meetings:

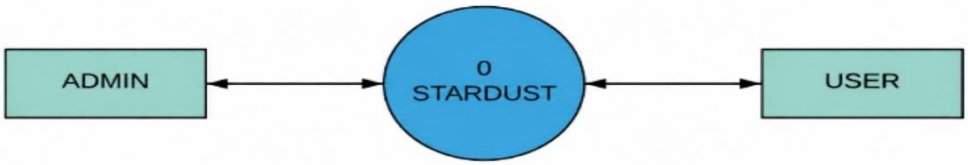
#	Name	Type	Null	Default	Extra
1	id	int(11)	No	None	AUTO_INCREMENT
2	pitch_id	int(11)	No	None	
3	investor_id	int(11)	No	None	
4	founder_id	int(11)	No	None	
5	proposed_datetime	datetime	No	None	
6	message	text	Yes	NULL	
7	status	enum('pending', 'confirmed', 'declined')	No	pending	
8	created_at	datetime	Yes	current_timestamp()	

3) pitches:

#	Name	Type	Null	Default	Extra
1	id	int(11)	No	None	AUTO_ INCREMENT
2	founder_id	int(11)	No	None	
3	startup_name	varchar(150)	No	None	
4	tagline	varchar(200)	Yes	NULL	
5	industry	varchar(80)	No	None	
6	funding_stage	varchar(60)	No	None	
7	business_model	varchar(60)	No	None	
8	funding_ask	int(11)	No	0	
9	team_size	int(11)	Yes	1	
10	website	varchar(200)	Yes	NULL	
11	description	text	No	None	
12	problem_statement	text	Yes	NULL	
13	traction	text	Yes	NULL	
14	deck_filename	varchar(255)	Yes	NULL	
15	deck_text_excerpt	text	Yes	NULL	
16	deck_keywords	varchar(500)	Yes	NULL	
17	status	enum('pending', 'in_review', 'shortlisted', 'rejec…')	No	pending	
18	submitted_at	datetime	Yes	current_ timestamp()	

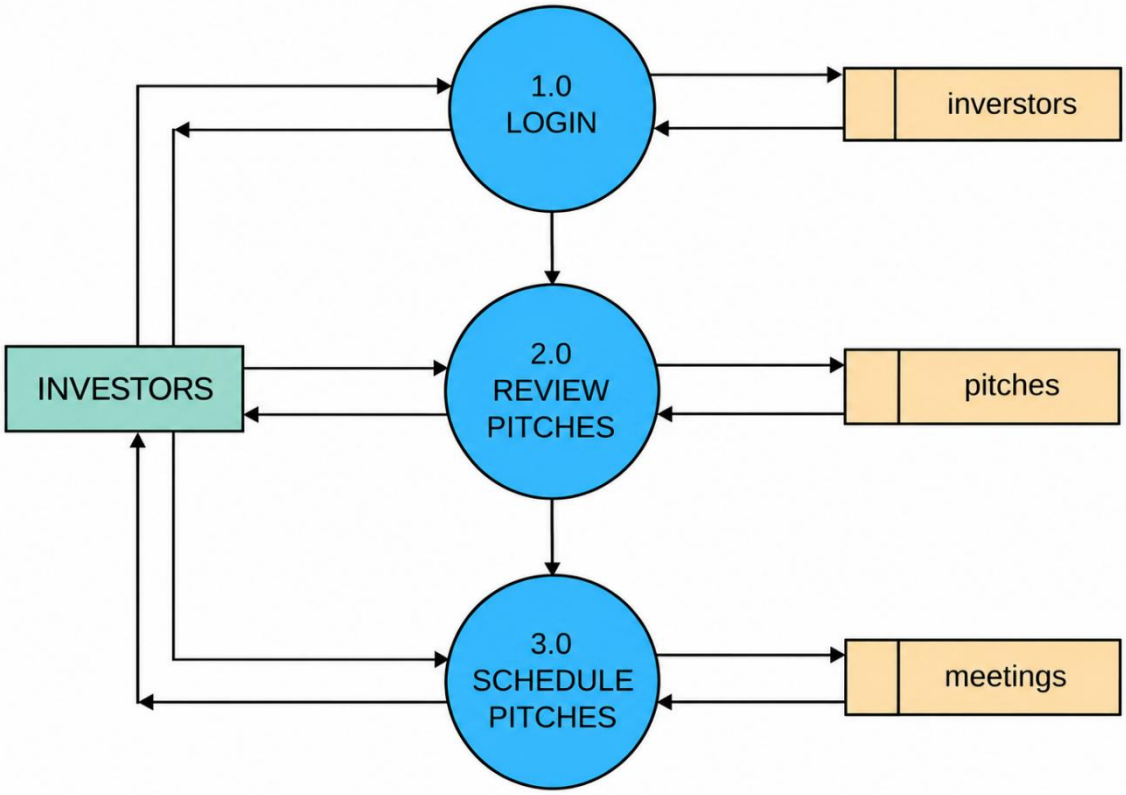
4.3Functional and behavior modeling

4.3.1 Context Diagram(0-level Diagram)

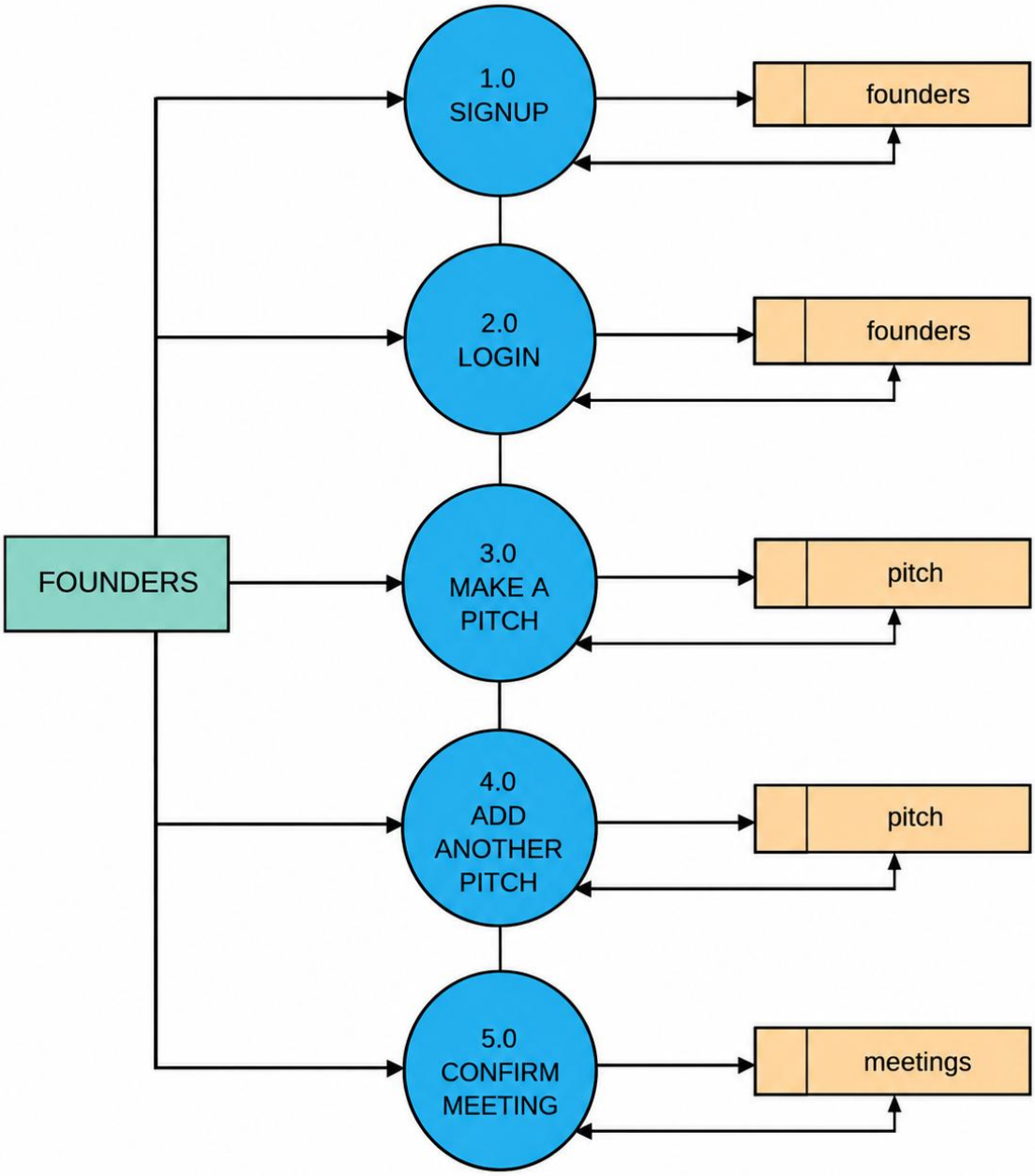


4.3.2 First Level Diagram (1-level Diagram)

- **Investor**



- **Founder**


FOUNDERS
1.0
SIGNUP
2.0
LOGIN
3.0
MAKE A
PITCH
4.0
ADD
ANOTHER
PITCH
5.0
CONFIRM
MEETING
founders
founders
pitch
pitch
meetings

4.4 Gantt Chart



- Expected Time.



- Actual Time.

No.	June	July	Aug	Sept	Oct
1	Requirement Gathering And SRS				
2	System Analysis				
3	System Design				
4	System Development				
5	System Testing				

5. TEST CASE

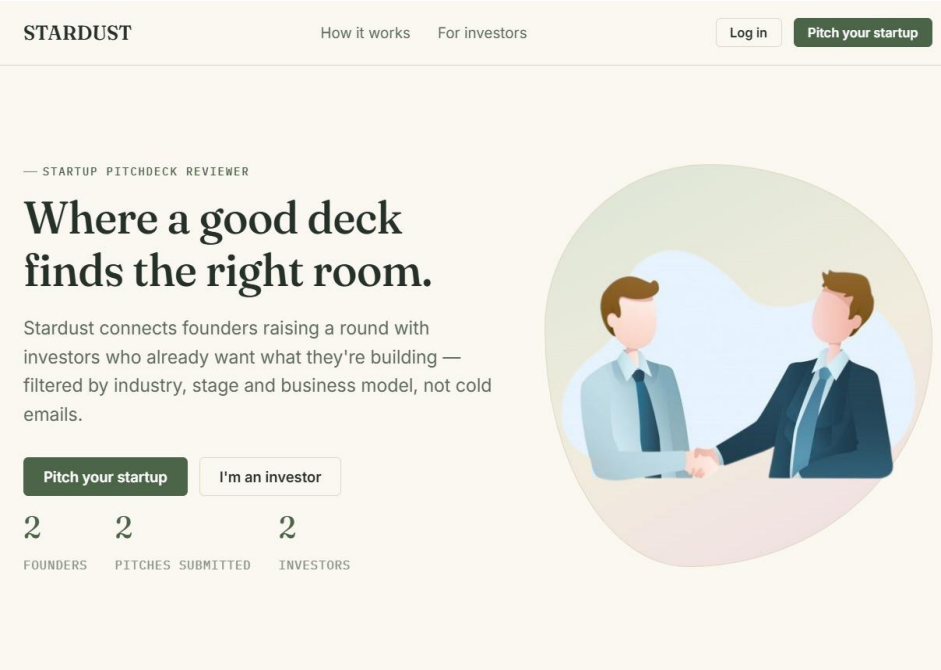
Login Module					
TEST CASE No. 1			TEST CASE DESIGN DATE : 5/Sept/2026		
TEST TITLE : Login Module Test			TEST CASE EXECUTION DATE : 5/Sept/2026		
DESCRIPTION : In this test case Login module would be tested					
PRECONDITION : Login Activity must be working					
STEP No.	TEST STEP	TEST DATA	EXPECTED RESULT	ACTUAL RESULT	STATUS
1	Navigate to Login Page	Login Activity	Login Activity is visible	Same As Expected	PASS
2	Enter Email	hpkariya@hotmail	Email is accepted	Same As Expected	FAIL
3	Enter Password	12345678	Password is accepted	Same As Expected	PASS
4	Click Login Button	Button Click	Check Credentials	Same As Expected	PASS

*Note:- Email is not accepted in above test case due to invalid format.

Signup Module					
TEST CASE No. 2			TEST CASE DESIGN DATE : 5/Sept/2026		
TEST TITLE : Signup Module Test			TEST CASE EXECUTION DATE : 5/Sept/2026		
DESCRIPTION : In this test case Signup Activity would be tested					
PRECONDITION : Signup Activity must be working					
STEP No.	TEST STEP	TEST DATA	EXPECTED RESULT	ACTUAL RESULT	STATUS
1	Navigate to Signup Activity	Signup Activity	Signup Activity is visible	Same As Expected	PASS
2	Enter All Fields	Data	Check Data Integrity	Same As Expected	PASS
4	Click Signup Button	Button Click	Signup done With all Validation	Same As Expected	PASS

6. SCREEN SHOTS

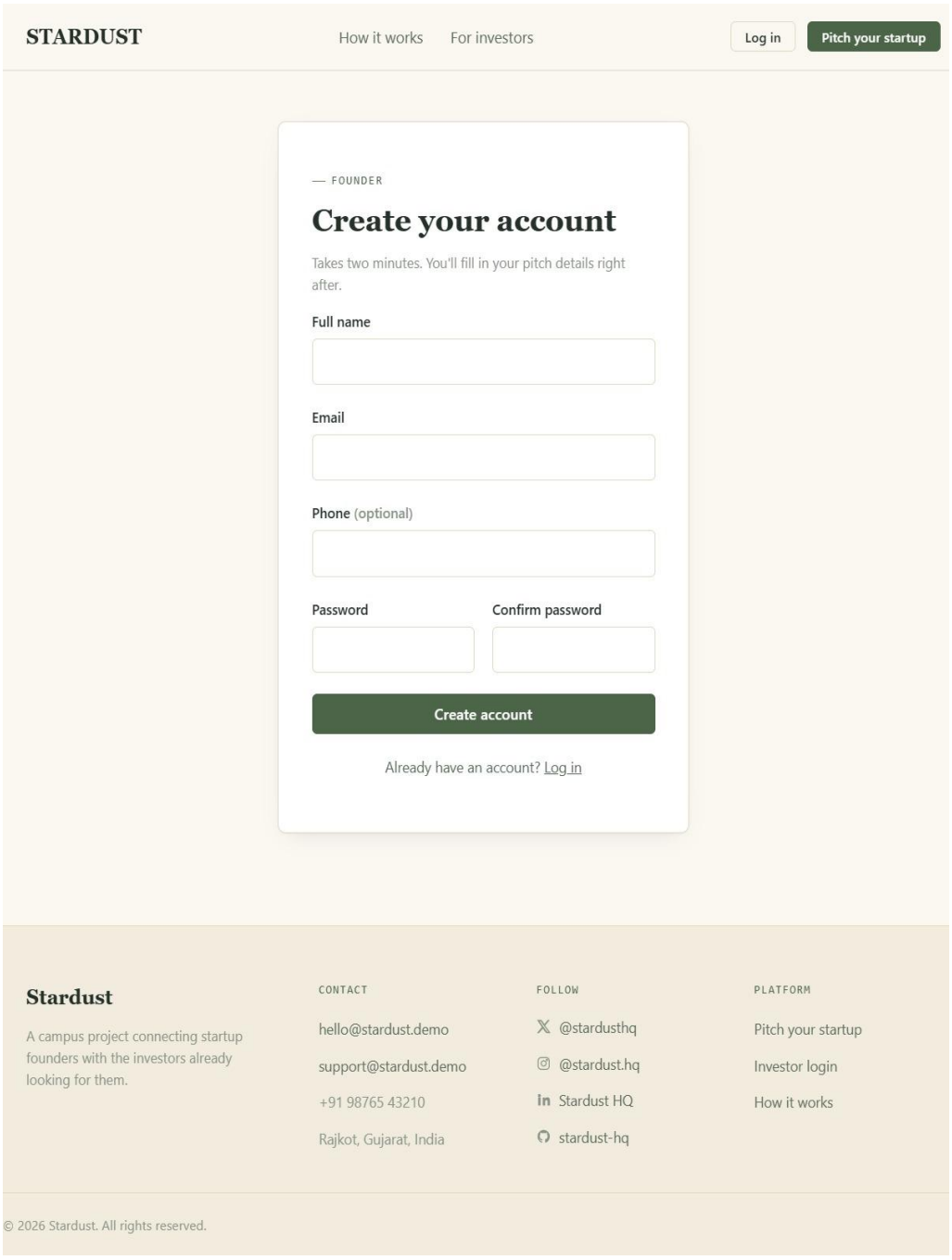
➢ Home page



6.1 This Activity Displays Home page.

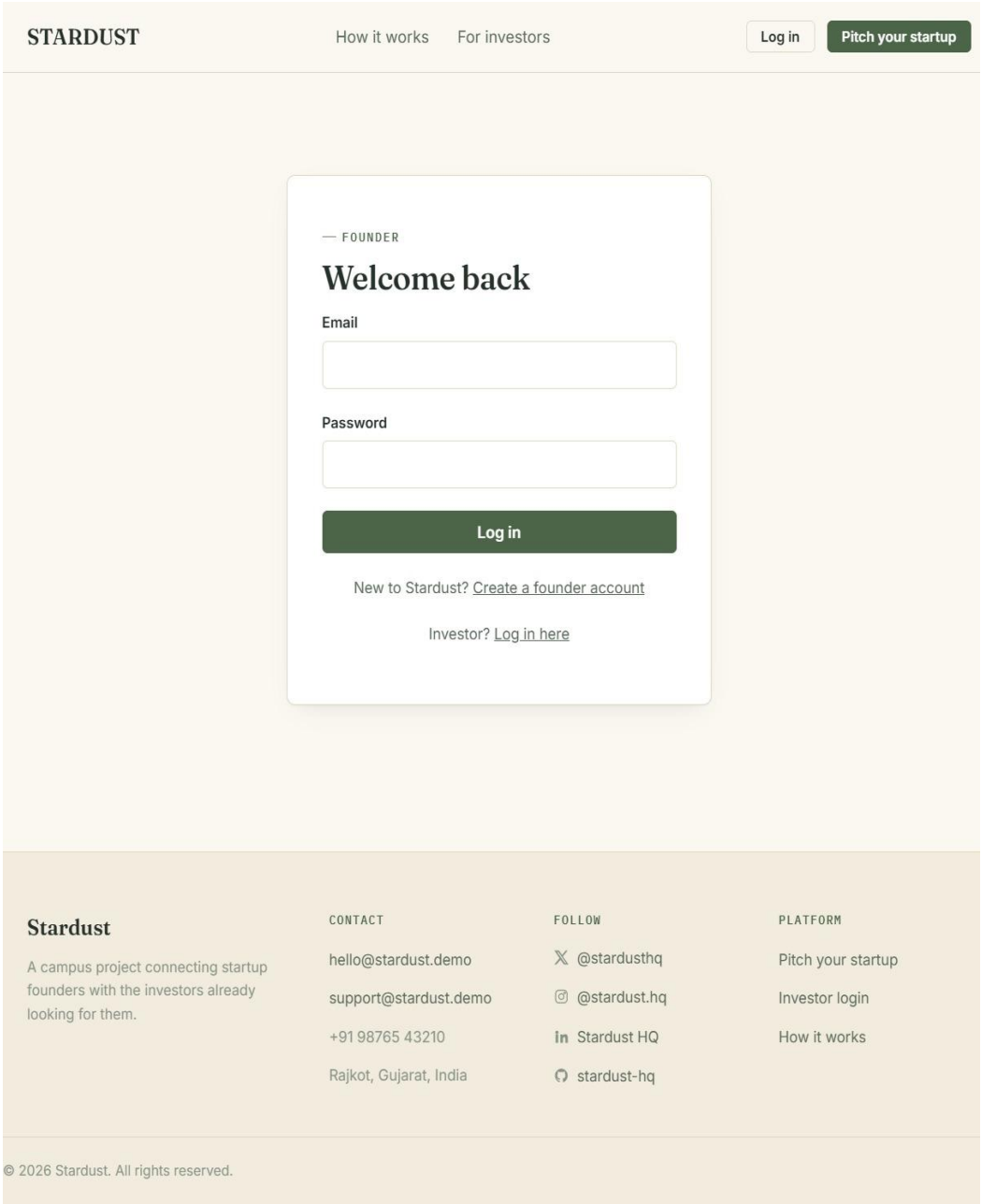
➢ Founder

• Founder Registration



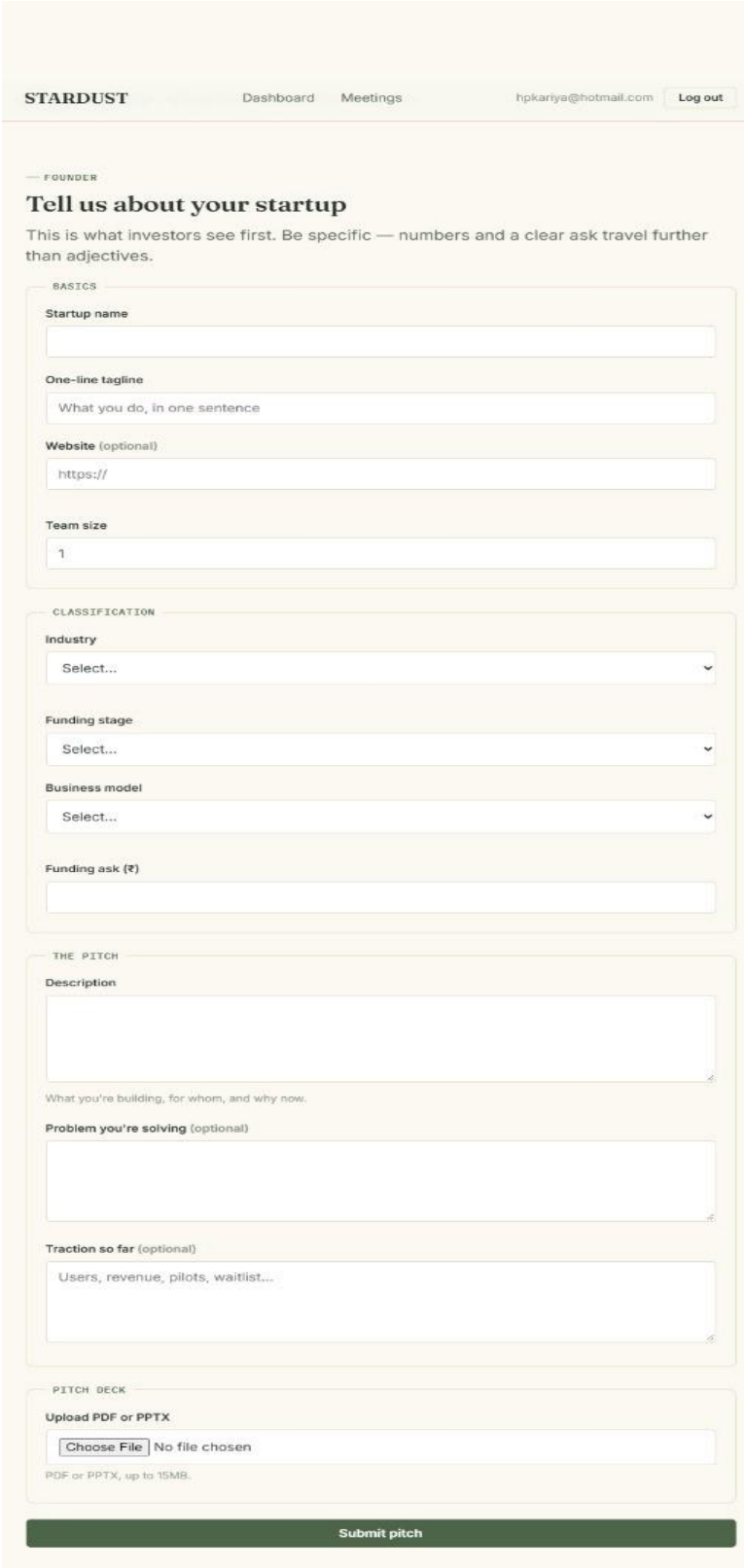
6.2.1 This Activity Displays Founder Create Account.

- **Founder Login**



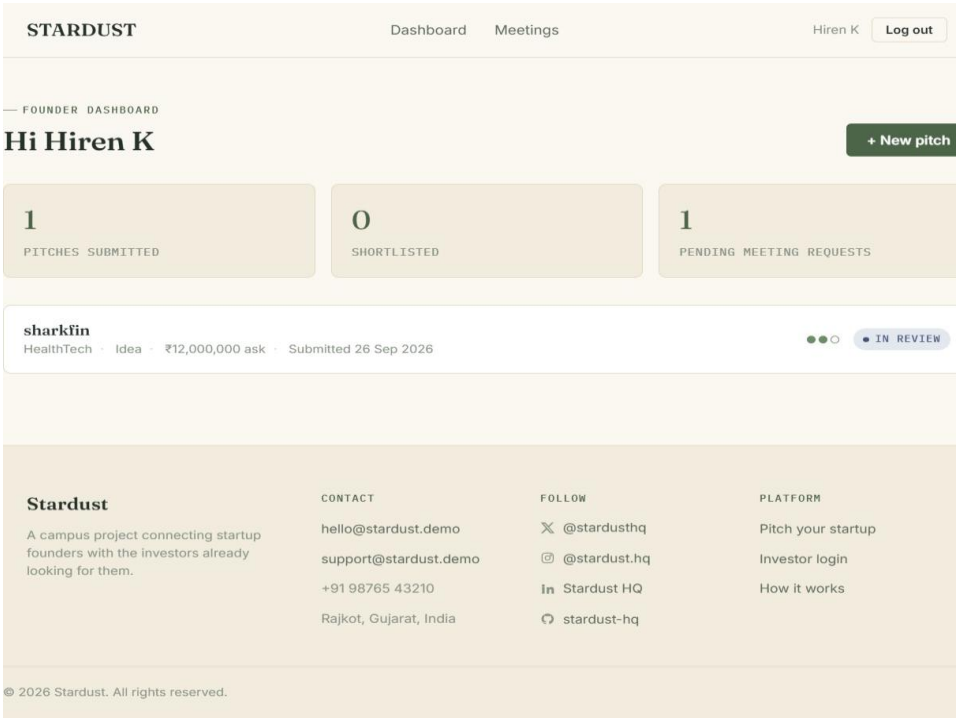
6.2.2 This Activity Displays Founder Login Screen.

- **Startup Pitch Registration**



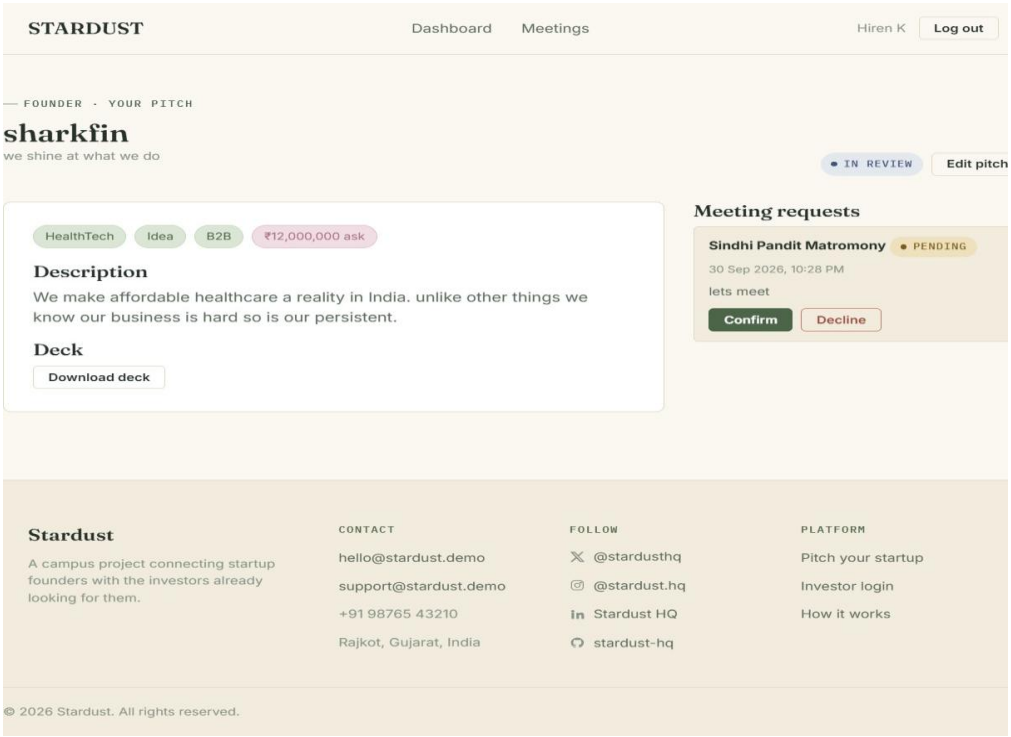
6.2.3 This Activity Displays Startup Pitch Registration.

- **Founder Dashboard**



6.2.4 This Activity Displays Founder Dashboard.

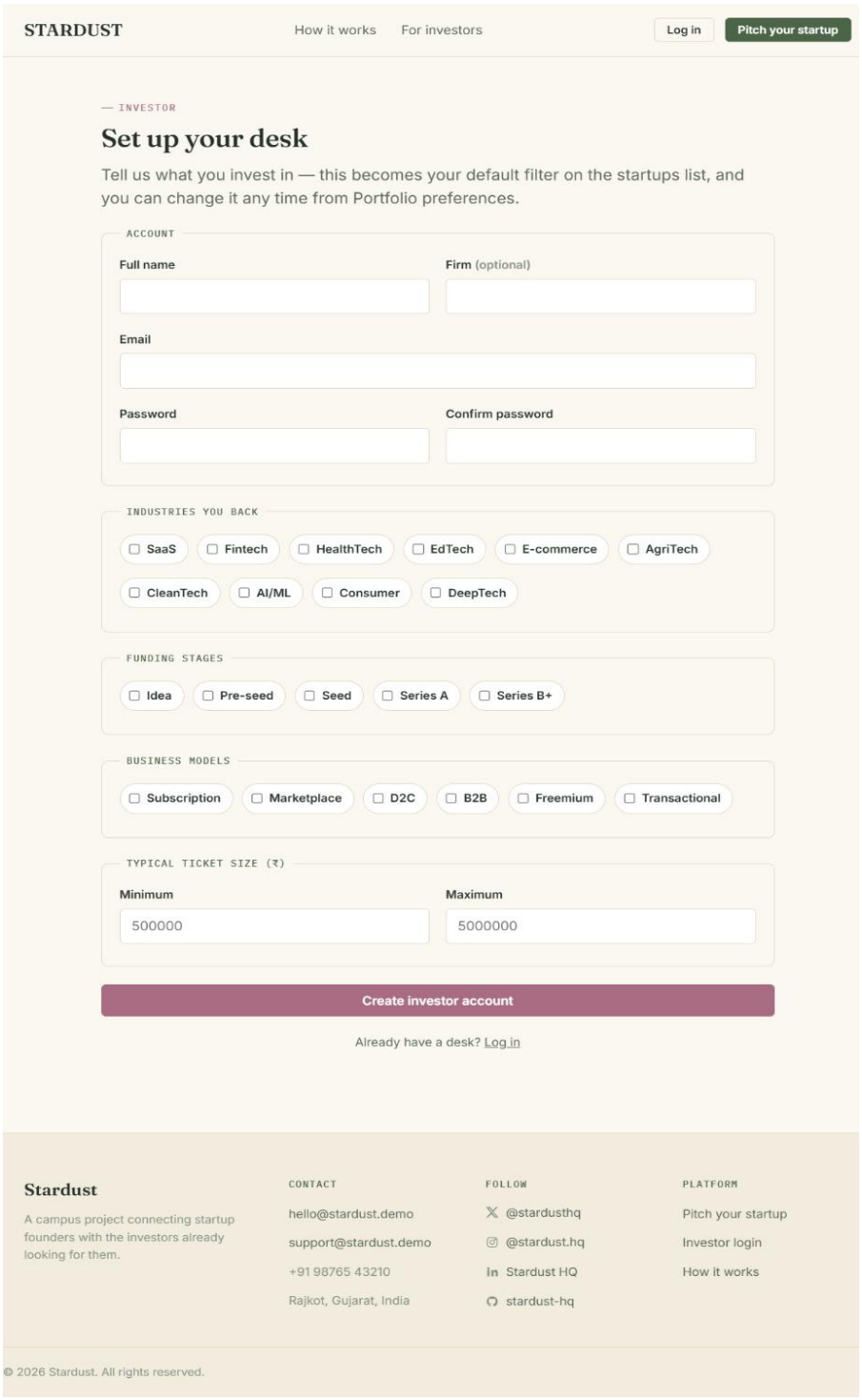
- **Your Startup Pitch Review**



6.2.5 This Activity Displays Your Pitch Review.

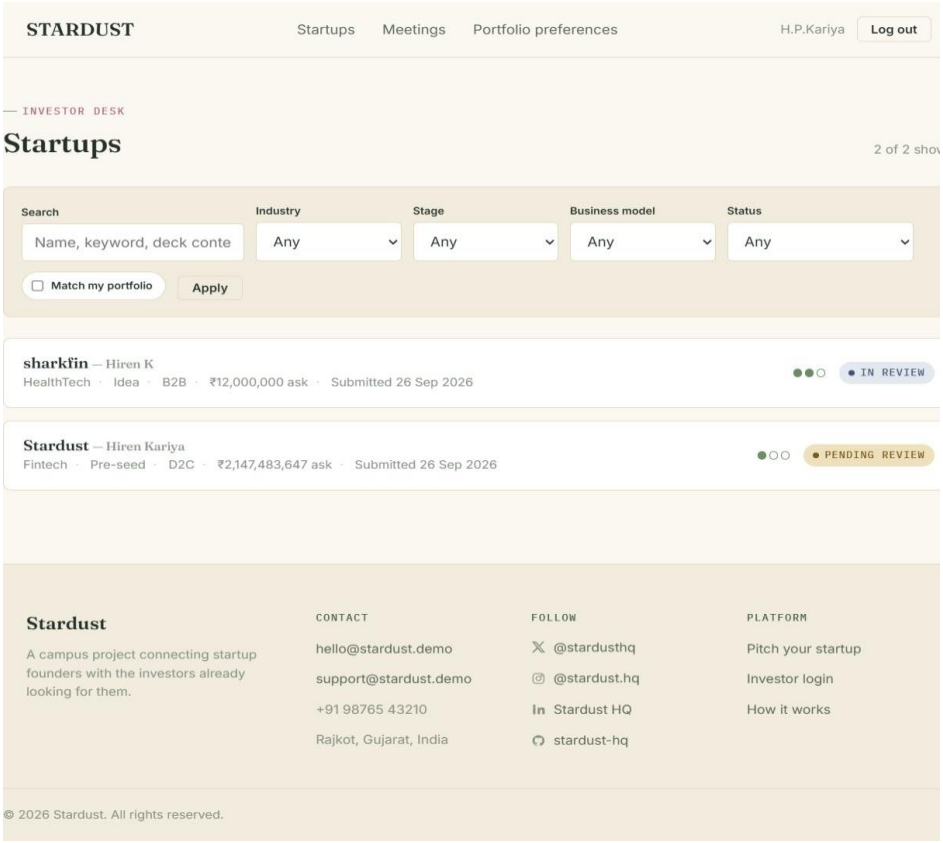
➢ Investor

• Investor Registration



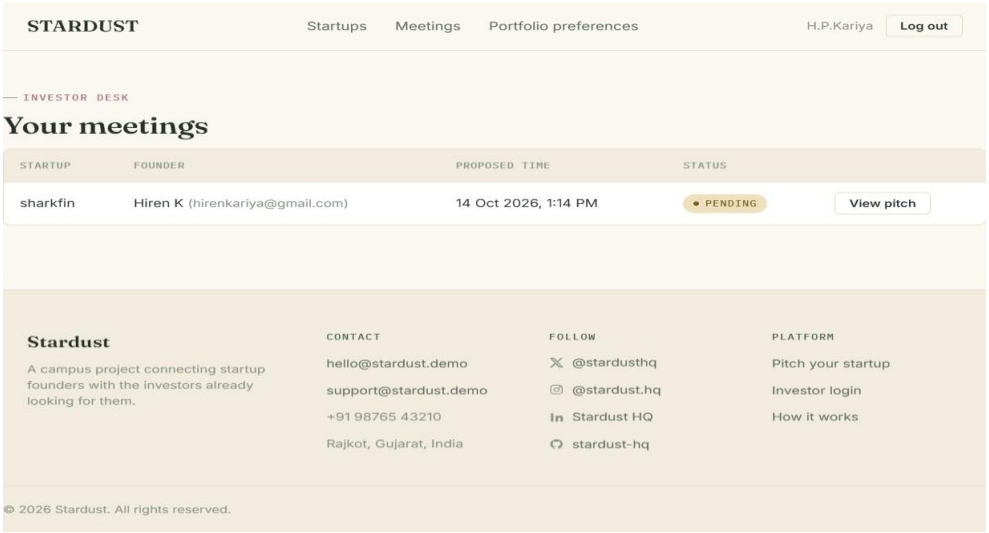
6.3.1 This Activity Displays Investor Registration.

- **Investor Dashboard**



6.3.2 User can download any of the listed PDF

- **Meeting panel**



6.3.3 This Activity Displays Forget Password Screen

7. CODE EXPLANATION

1) Module Name: - Database Connection

```php
<?php
/**
 * PDO database connection, shared everywhere via require.
 */
require_once __DIR__ . '/config.php';

function db(): PDO
{
    static $pdo = null;
    if ($pdo === null) {
        $dsn = 'mysql:host=' . DB_HOST . ';dbname=' . DB_NAME . ';charset=utf8mb4';
        try {
            $pdo = new PDO($dsn, DB_USER, DB_PASS, [
                PDO::ATTR_ERRMODE => PDO::ERRMODE_EXCEPTION,
                PDO::ATTR_DEFAULT_FETCH_MODE => PDO::FETCH_ASSOC,
                PDO::ATTR_EMULATE_PREPARES => false,
            ]);
        } catch (PDOException $e) {
            http_response_code(500);
            die('Database connection failed. Check config/config.php credentials and that stardust_db has been imported from sql/schema.sql. (' . $e->getMessage() . ')');
        }
    }
    return $pdo;
}

```

Purpose: -

This module establishes a connection between the Stardust application and the MySQL database using PDO. It also handles database errors and sets secure PDO options.

Code Explanation:

- require_once → Loads the database configuration file.
- db() → Creates and returns the database connection.
- $dsn → Defines the MySQL database connection details.
- new PDO() → Creates the connection with the database.
- PDO::ATTR_ERRMODE → Enables exception-based error handling.
- PDO::ATTR_DEFAULT_FETCH_MODE → Fetches database records as associative arrays.
- PDO::ATTR_EMULATE_PREPARES → Disables emulated prepared statements.
- catch (PDOException $e) → Handles database connection errors.
- return $pdo → Returns the active database connection.

2) Module Name: - Founder Login

```php
<?php
require_once __DIR__ . '/config/db.php';
require_once __DIR__ . '/includes/auth.php';

if (current_founder()) redirect(BASE_URL . '/founder/dashboard.php');

$error = null;
$email = '';

if ($_SERVER['REQUEST_METHOD'] === 'POST') {
    verify_csrf();
    $email = trim(strtolower($_POST['email'] ?? ''));
    $password = $_POST['password'] ?? '';

    $stmt = db()->prepare('SELECT * FROM founders WHERE email = ?');
    $stmt->execute([$email]);
    $row = $stmt->fetch();

    if ($row && password_verify($password, $row['password_hash'])) {
        login_founder($row);
        redirect(BASE_URL . '/founder/dashboard.php');
    } else {
        $error = 'Incorrect email or password.';
    }
}
```

Purpose: -

This module authenticates founders by checking their email and password against the founders table and redirects successfully logged-in founders to their dashboard.

Code Explanation:

- require_once → Loads the database and authentication functions.
- current_founder() → Checks whether a founder is already logged in.
- $_SERVER['REQUEST_METHOD'] → Checks whether the login form was submitted.
- verify_csrf() → Verifies the CSRF security token.
- $_POST['email'] → Gets the email entered by the founder.
- $_POST['password'] → Gets the entered password.
- db()->prepare() → Prepares the SQL query to find the founder.
- execute([$email]) → Executes the query using the entered email.
- fetch() → Retrieves the matching founder record.
- password_verify() → Checks the entered password against the stored password hash.
- login_founder() → Creates the founder login session.
- redirect() → Sends the founder to the dashboard after successful login.
- $error → Displays an error when the login credentials are incorrect.

3) Module Name: - Founder Registration

```php
<?php
require_once __DIR__ . '/config/db.php';
require_once __DIR__ . '/includes/auth.php';

if (current_founder()) redirect(BASE_URL . '/founder/dashboard.php');

$errors = [];
$full_name = $email = $phone = '';

if ($_SERVER['REQUEST_METHOD'] === 'POST') {
    verify_csrf();
    $full_name = trim($_POST['full_name'] ?? '');
    $email = trim(strtolower($_POST['email'] ?? ''));
    $phone = trim($_POST['phone'] ?? '');
    $password = $_POST['password'] ?? '';
    $confirm = $_POST['confirm_password'] ?? '';

    if (mb_strlen($full_name) < 2) $errors[] = 'Please enter your full name.';
    if (!filter_var($email, FILTER_VALIDATE_EMAIL)) $errors[] = 'Please enter a valid email address.';
    if (mb_strlen($password) < 8) $errors[] = 'Password must be at least 8 characters.';
    if ($password !== $confirm) $errors[] = 'Passwords do not match.';

    if (!$errors) {
        $stmt = db()->prepare('SELECT id FROM founders WHERE email = ?');
        $stmt->execute([$email]);
        if ($stmt->fetch()) $errors[] = 'An account with that email already exists.';
    }

    if (!$errors) {
        $hash = password_hash($password, PASSWORD_DEFAULT);
        $stmt = db()->prepare('INSERT INTO founders (full_name, email, password_hash, phone) VALUES (?, ?, ?, ?)');
        $stmt->execute([$full_name, $email, $hash, $phone ?: null]);
        $row = ['id' => db()->lastInsertId(), 'full_name' => $full_name, 'email' => $email];
        login_founder($row);
        flash('success', 'Welcome to Stardust 🚀 let\'s get your pitch in front of investors.');
        redirect(BASE_URL . '/founder/pitch_form.php');
    }
```

Purpose: -

This module allows a new founder to create an account. It validates the submitted information, checks whether the email already exists, securely hashes the password, and inserts the founder into the database.

Code Explanation:

- $_SERVER['REQUEST_METHOD'] → Checks whether the registration form was submitted.
- verify_csrf() → Verifies the CSRF security token.
- $_POST → Retrieves founder registration information.
- mb_strlen() → Validates the length of the founder's name and password.
- filter_var() → Validates the email address.
- Password comparison → Checks whether both passwords match.
- SELECT id FROM founders → Checks whether email already exists.
- password_hash() → Securely hashes the founder's password.
- INSERT INTO founders → Stores the new founder's information in the database.
- lastInsertId() → Gets the ID of the newly created founder.
- login_founder() → Logs the founder in after successful registration.
- redirect() → Sends the founder to the pitch form.

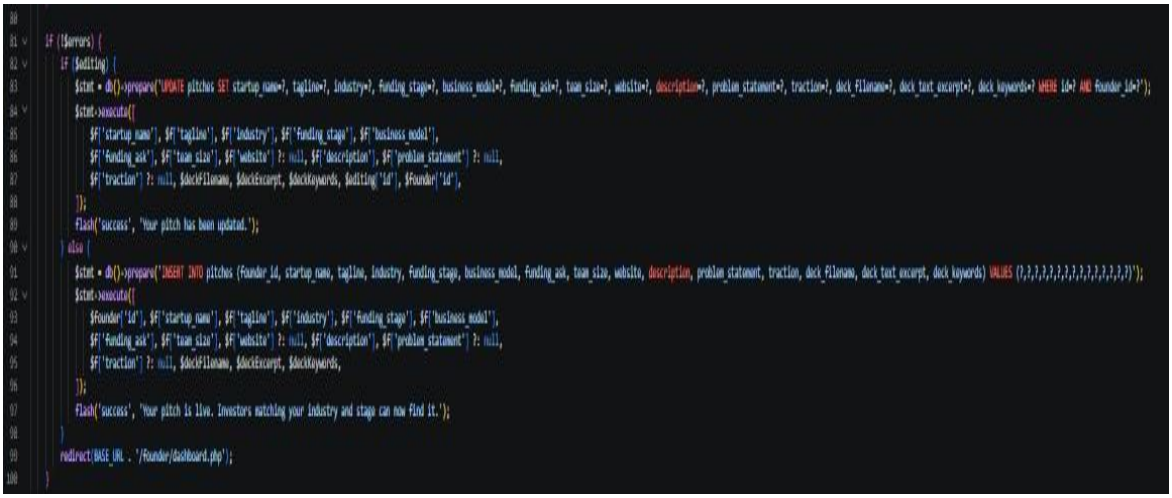
4) **Module Name**: - Pitch Submission and Deck Analysis

```php
if ($_SERVER['REQUEST_METHOD'] === 'POST') {
    verify_csrf();
    $f['startup_name'] = trim($_POST['startup_name'] ?? '');
    $f['tagline'] = trim($_POST['tagline'] ?? '');
    $f['industry'] = trim($_POST['industry'] ?? '');
    $f['funding_stage'] = trim($_POST['funding_stage'] ?? '');
    $f['business_model'] = trim($_POST['business_model'] ?? '');
    $f['funding_ask'] = (int) ($_POST['funding_ask'] ?? 0);
    $f['team_size'] = (int) ($_POST['team_size'] ?? 1);
    $f['website'] = trim($_POST['website'] ?? '');
    $f['description'] = trim($_POST['description'] ?? '');
    $f['problem_statement'] = trim($_POST['problem_statement'] ?? '');
    $f['traction'] = trim($_POST['traction'] ?? '');

    if (mb_strlen($f['startup_name']) < 2) $errors[] = 'Startup name is required.';
    if (!in_array($f['industry'], $INDUSTRIES, true)) $errors[] = 'Please choose an industry.';
    if (!in_array($f['funding_stage'], $STAGES, true)) $errors[] = 'Please choose a funding stage.';
    if (!in_array($f['business_model'], $MODELS, true)) $errors[] = 'Please choose a business model.';
    if ($f['funding_ask'] <= 0) $errors[] = 'Please enter how much you are raising.';
    if (mb_strlen($f['description']) < 30) $errors[] = 'Please describe your startup in at least a few sentences.';
    if ($f['website'] && !filter_var($f['website'], FILTER_VALIDATE_URL)) $errors[] = 'Website URL looks invalid.';

    // ---- Deck upload (optional on edit, required on first submission) ----
    $deckFilename = $editing['deck_filename'] ?? null;
    $deckExcerpt = $editing['deck_text_excerpt'] ?? null;
    $deckKeywords = $editing['deck_keywords'] ?? null;

    if (!empty($_FILES['deck']['name'])) {
        $file = $_FILES['deck'];
        if ($file['error'] !== UPLOAD_ERR_OK) {
            $errors[] = 'Deck upload failed. Please try again.';
        } else {
            $ext = strtolower(pathinfo($file['name'], PATHINFO_EXTENSION));
            $sizeMb = $file['size'] / 1024 / 1024;
            if (!in_array($ext, ALLOWED_DECK_TYPES, true)) {
                $errors[] = 'Deck must be a PDF or PPTX file.';
            } elseif ($sizeMb > MAX_DECK_SIZE_MB) {
                $errors[] = 'Deck must be under ' . MAX_DECK_SIZE_MB . 'MB.';
            } else {
                if (!is_dir(UPLOAD_DIR)) mkdir(UPLOAD_DIR, 0755, true);
                $safeName = 'deck_' . $founder['id'] . '_' . time() . '_' . bin2hex(random_bytes(4)) . '.' . $ext;
                $dest = UPLOAD_DIR . '/' . $safeName;
                if (move_uploaded_file($file['tmp_name'], $dest)) {
                    $deckFilename = $safeName;
                    $analysis = analyze_deck_file($dest, $ext);
                    $deckExcerpt = $analysis['excerpt'];
                    $deckKeywords = $analysis['keywords'];
                } else {
                    $errors[] = 'Could not save the uploaded deck. Check server upload permissions.';
                }
            }
        }
    } elseif (!$editing) {
        $errors[] = 'Please upload your pitch deck (PDF or PPTX).';
    }
```



```
80
81  if (!$errors) {
82      if ($editing) {
83          $stmt = db()->prepare('UPDATE pitches SET startup_name=?, tagline=?, industry=?, funding_stage=?, business_model=?, funding_ask=?, team_size=?, website=?, description=?, problem_statement=?, traction=?, deck_filename=?, deck_text_excerpt=?, deck_keywords=? WHERE id=? AND founder_id=?');
84          $stmt->execute([
85              $f['startup_name'], $f['tagline'], $f['industry'], $f['funding_stage'], $f['business_model'],
86              $f['funding_ask'], $f['team_size'], $f['website'] ?: null, $f['description'], $f['problem_statement'] ?: null,
87              $f['traction'] ?: null, $deckFilename, $deckExcerpt, $deckKeywords, $editing['id'], $founder['id'],
88          ]);
89          flash('success', 'Your pitch has been updated.');
90      } else {
91          $stmt = db()->prepare('INSERT INTO pitches (founder_id, startup_name, tagline, industry, funding_stage, business_model, funding_ask, team_size, website, description, problem_statement, traction, deck_filename, deck_text_excerpt, deck_keywords) VALUES (?,?,?,?,?,?,?,?,?,?,?,?,?,?,?)');
92          $stmt->execute([
93              $founder['id'], $f['startup_name'], $f['tagline'], $f['industry'], $f['funding_stage'], $f['business_model'],
94              $f['funding_ask'], $f['team_size'], $f['website'] ?: null, $f['description'], $f['problem_statement'] ?: null,
95              $f['traction'] ?: null, $deckFilename, $deckExcerpt, $deckKeywords,
96          ]);
97          flash('success', 'Your pitch is live. Investors matching your industry and stage can now find it.');
98      }
99      redirect(BASE_URL . '/founder/dashboard.php');
100 }
```

Purpose: -

This module allows founders to submit or edit startup pitches. It validates startup information, accepts PDF/PPTX pitch decks, stores uploaded decks, performs deck analysis, and saves the pitch information in the database.

Code Explanation:

- require_founder() → Ensures that only logged-in founders can submit pitches.
- $_GET['id'] → Checks whether an existing pitch is being edited.
- SELECT * FROM pitches → Retrieves the founder's existing pitch.
- $INDUSTRIES → Contains the available startup industries.
- $STAGES → Contains the available funding stages.
- $MODELS → Contains the available business models.
- $_POST → Retrieves the submitted pitch information.
- verify_csrf() → Provides CSRF protection for the form.
- Validation → Checks startup name, industry, funding stage, business model, funding amount, description, and website.
- $_FILES['deck'] → Receives the uploaded pitch deck.
- ALLOWED_DECK_TYPES → Restricts the pitch deck file type.
- MAX_DECK_SIZE_MB → Checks the maximum allowed file size.
- move_uploaded_file() → Saves the uploaded deck.
- analyze_deck_file() → Sends the uploaded deck for text and keyword analysis.
- $deckExcerpt → Stores the extracted text excerpt.
- $deckKeywords → Stores the extracted keywords.
- UPDATE pitches → Updates an existing pitch.
- INSERT INTO pitches → Creates a new pitch.
- redirect() → Returns the founder to the dashboard after successful submission.

5) Module Name: - Investor Dashboard and Pitch Filtering

```php
$stmt = db()->prepare('SELECT * FROM investor_preferences WHERE investor_id = ?');
$stmt->execute([$investor['id']]);
$prefs = $stmt->fetch() ?: [];

$matchOnly = isset($_GET['match']) && $_GET['match'] === '1';
$industry = $_GET['industry'] ?? '';
$stage = $_GET['stage'] ?? '';
$model = $_GET['model'] ?? '';
$status = $_GET['status'] ?? '';
$q = trim($_GET['q'] ?? '');

$where = [];
$params = [];

if ($matchOnly) {
    $prefIndustries = csv_to_array($prefs['industries'] ?? '');
    $prefStages = csv_to_array($prefs['funding_stages'] ?? '');
    $prefModels = csv_to_array($prefs['business_models'] ?? '');
    if ($prefIndustries) { $where[] = 'industry IN (' . implode(',', array_fill(0, count($prefIndustries), '?')) . ')'; array_push($params, ...$prefIndustries); }
    if ($prefStages) { $where[] = 'funding_stage IN (' . implode(',', array_fill(0, count($prefStages), '?')) . ')'; array_push($params, ...$prefStages); }
    if ($prefModels) { $where[] = 'business_model IN (' . implode(',', array_fill(0, count($prefModels), '?')) . ')'; array_push($params, ...$prefModels); }
    if (!empty($prefs['ticket_size_min'])) { $where[] = 'funding_ask >= ?'; $params[] = (int) $prefs['ticket_size_min']; }
    if (!empty($prefs['ticket_size_max'])) { $where[] = 'funding_ask <= ?'; $params[] = (int) $prefs['ticket_size_max']; }
}

if ($industry) { $where[] = 'industry = ?'; $params[] = $industry; }
if ($stage) { $where[] = 'funding_stage = ?'; $params[] = $stage; }
if ($model) { $where[] = 'business_model = ?'; $params[] = $model; }
if ($status) { $where[] = 'status = ?'; $params[] = $status; }
if ($q !== '') { $where[] = '(startup_name LIKE ? OR tagline LIKE ? OR description LIKE ? OR deck_keywords LIKE ?)'; array_push($params, "%$q%", "%$q%", "%$q%", "%$q%"); }

$sql = 'SELECT p.*, f.full_name AS founder_name, f.email AS founder_email FROM pitches p JOIN founders f ON f.id = p.founder_id';
if ($where) $sql .= ' WHERE ' . implode(' AND ', $where);
$sql .= ' ORDER BY p.submitted_at DESC';

$stmt = db()->prepare($sql);
$stmt->execute($params);
$pitches = $stmt->fetchAll();
```

Purpose: -

This module displays startup pitches to investors and provides filtering and searching based on industry, funding stage, business model, status, keywords, and investor portfolio preferences.

Code Explanation:

- require_investor() → Ensures that only logged-in investors can access the dashboard.
- investor_preferences → Retrieves the investor's portfolio preferences.
- $matchOnly → Checks whether portfolio matching is enabled.
- csv_to_array() → Converts stored comma-separated preferences into arrays.
- $where → Stores SQL filtering conditions.
- $params → Stores parameters used by the prepared SQL query.
- industry → Filters startups according to industry.
- stage → Filters startups according to funding stage.
- model → Filters startups according to business model.
- status → Filters pitches according to their current status.
- $q → Searches startup name, tagline, description, or deck keywords.
- JOIN founders → Retrieves founder information with each pitch.
- prepare() → Prepares the filtered SQL query.
- fetchAll() → Retrieves the matching startup pitches.

- ring_stage_admin() → Determines the visual stage of the pitch status.

6) Module Name: - Investor Pitch Review and Meeting Scheduling



```php
$stmt = db()->prepare('SELECT p.*, f.full_name AS founder_name, f.email AS founder_email, f.phone AS founder_phone FROM pitches p JOIN founders f ON f.id = p.founder_id WHERE p.id = ?');
$stmt->execute([(int) ($_GET['id'] ?? 0)]);
$pitch = $stmt->fetch();
if (!$pitch) { flash('error', 'Pitch not found.'); redirect(BASE_URL . '/admin/dashboard.php'); }

// ---- Handle actions ----
if ($_SERVER['REQUEST_METHOD'] === 'POST') {
    verify_csrf();

    if (isset($_POST['update_status'])) {
        $newStatus = $_POST['status'];
        if (in_array($newStatus, ['pending', 'in_review', 'shortlisted', 'rejected'], true)) {
            $stmt = db()->prepare('UPDATE pitches SET status = ? WHERE id = ?');
            $stmt->execute([$newStatus, $pitch['id']]);
            flash('success', 'Status updated.');
        }
        redirect(BASE_URL . '/admin/pitch_detail.php?id=' . $pitch['id']);
    }

    if (isset($_POST['add_note'])) {
        $note = trim($_POST['note'] ?? '');
        if ($note !== '') {
            $stmt = db()->prepare('INSERT INTO investor_notes (pitch_id, investor_id, note) VALUES (?, ?, ?)');
            $stmt->execute([$pitch['id'], $investor['id'], $note]);
            flash('success', 'Note added.');
        }
        redirect(BASE_URL . '/admin/pitch_detail.php?id=' . $pitch['id']);
    }

    if (isset($_POST['schedule_meeting'])) {
        $when = $_POST['proposed_datetime'] ?? '';
        $msg = trim($_POST['message'] ?? '');
        if ($when) {
            $stmt = db()->prepare('INSERT INTO meetings (pitch_id, investor_id, founder_id, proposed_datetime, message) VALUES (?, ?, ?, ?, ?)');
            $stmt->execute([$pitch['id'], $investor['id'], $pitch['founder_id'], str_replace('T', ' ', $when), $msg ?: null]);
            flash('success', 'Meeting request sent to the founder.');
        } else {
            flash('error', 'Pick a date and time first.');
        }
        redirect(BASE_URL . '/admin/pitch_detail.php?id=' . $pitch['id']);
    }
}

$stmt = db()->prepare('SELECT n.*, i.full_name AS investor_name FROM investor_notes n JOIN investors i ON i.id = n.investor_id WHERE n.pitch_id = ? ORDER BY n.created_at DESC');
$stmt->execute([$pitch['id']]);
$notes = $stmt->fetchAll();

$stmt = db()->prepare("SELECT m.*, i.full_name AS investor_name, i.firm_name FROM meetings m JOIN investors i ON i.id = m.investor_id WHERE m.pitch_id = ? ORDER BY m.proposed_datetime DESC");
$stmt->execute([$pitch['id']]);
```

Purpose: -

This module allows investors to view startup pitch information, update the pitch status, add internal notes, and schedule meetings with founders.

Code Explanation:

- require_investor() → Checks that the user is an authenticated investor.
- SELECT p.* FROM pitches → Retrieves the selected pitch.
- JOIN founders → Gets founder information associated with the pitch.
- $_GET['id'] → Identifies the pitch being reviewed.
- verify_csrf() → Protects POST operations against CSRF attacks.
- update_status → Detects when the investor changes the pitch status.
- UPDATE pitches → Saves the new pitch status.
- add_note → Detects when an investor adds an internal note.
- INSERT INTO investor_notes → Stores the investor's note.
- schedule_meeting → Processes a meeting request.
- INSERT INTO meetings → Stores the proposed meeting details.
- SELECT n.* → Retrieves internal notes for the pitch.
- SELECT m.* → Retrieves scheduled meetings associated with the pitch.

- redirect() → Returns the investor to the pitch detail page after an operation.

7) Module Name: - Pitch Deck Analysis

```
STOPWORDS = set("""
a an the and or but if then else for of to in on at by with as is are was
were be been being this that these those it its it's we our you your they
their he she his her from into over under about above below up down out
not no nor so than too very can will just also more most such only own
company startup startups product products team market users user customer
customers business plan slide deck pitch page
""".split())

MIN_WORD_LEN = 4
MAX_EXCERPT_CHARS = 900
TOP_KEYWORDS = 12


def extract_pdf_text(path):
    try:
        import pdfplumber
        text_parts = []
        with pdfplumber.open(path) as pdf:
            for pg in pdf.pages[:12]:
                t = pg.extract_text()
                if t:
                    text_parts.append(t)
        return "\n".join(text_parts), None
```

Purpose: -

This Python module extracts text from uploaded PDF or PowerPoint pitch decks and generates an excerpt and important keywords that can be stored and displayed with the startup pitch.

Code Explanation:

- extract_pdf_text() → Extracts text from PDF files.
- pdfplumber → Attempts to read text from PDF pages.
- PyPDF2 → Provides a fallback PDF text extraction method.
- extract_pptx_text() → Extracts text from PowerPoint files.
- top_keywords() → Finds frequently occurring keywords.
- re.findall() → Extracts words from the deck text.
- STOPWORDS → Removes common words from keyword analysis.
- Counter() → Counts keyword occurrences.
- TOP_KEYWORDS → Limits the number of keywords returned.
- main() → Controls the deck analysis process.
- sys.argv → Receives the deck path and file type.

- extract_pdf_text() / extract_pptx_text() → Processes the selected file type.
- excerpt → Stores the first part of the extracted text.
- keywords → Stores the most common keywords.
- json.dumps() → Returns the analysis result in JSON format.

8. LIMITATIONS AND FUTURE ENHANCEMENT

➢ Limitations :-

- The limitation of Stardust is that, Investor and founders can not interact other than a scheduled meeting.

• Future Enhancement:-

- In future, overall application designing will be improved.
- User management rights would be provided to admin.
- Profile based progress work would be shown to user in future.
- All other limitations would be removed.

9. CONCLUSION

The project report entitled Stardust has been completed successfully. This android application has been developed with much care that is free of errors and at a same time it is efficient and less time consuming. I have tried my level best to make this webapp as dynamic as possible. Also provision is provided for future development in the web app. This web app will be approved and implemented soon.

10. REFERENCES AND BIBLIOGRAPHY

All the references listed below were used to develop and design this web app and were also used for documentation. I am thankful to each and every person who helped me and supported for this project completion.

➢ Books :-

- PHP & MySQL by Jon Duckett

➢ Websites:-

- www.rainmatter.com
- www.zerodha.com
- www.w3school.com